

Defense of God and Jesus Christ

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September 8, 2025

Abstract

This paper presents a reasoned defense of the existence of God and the divine nature of Jesus Christ. It engages with common arguments posed by atheists, examines philosophical and scientific considerations, and provides case studies to support the coherence of faith with reason. Special attention is given to misconceptions surrounding prayer and divine intervention, illustrating that skepticism often arises from misunderstanding the nature of God and the limitations of human perspective.

1 The Misconception of Testing God: A Case Study of Richard Dawkins' Experiment

Richard Dawkins, in his book, argues that miracles do not work and describes an experiment he conducted to test whether prayers could aid sick and ailing patients.¹ According to him, the results demonstrated that prayer had no measurable effect. However, this reasoning contains a fundamental flaw.

Jesus Christ clearly instructs, "Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God."² The implication is that attempting to test God, particularly in matters of human health and life, is inherently problematic.

An illustrative example exists in modern media: a famous video shows a man on YouTube challenging God by claiming, "God ain't real, if God exists there would be a lightning strike in 3...2...1..." Remarkably, a lightning strike occurred. Remarkably, a lightning strike occurred.³

In Dawkins' experimental setup, the attempt to manipulate divine intervention for scientific purposes is ethically and spiritually questionable. It involves using human lives as variables in a test, which God does not condone. The failure of such experiments is not proof against the existence of God; rather, it reflects the principle that God does not operate under human-imposed experimental conditions.

Furthermore, prayer is not a magical tool to enforce personal desires. It functions in accordance with the greater good and divine will, rather than human selfish motives. As expressed in the Lord's Prayer:

Thy Kingdom come, Thy will be done.

Hence, prayer is about aligning oneself with the will of the Almighty, not commanding outcomes. Testing God for personal gain or scientific curiosity misunderstands the nature of divine interaction. Nevertheless, it is possible to defend God's existence and providence through careful reasoning and evidence, without attempting to "test" Him.

2 Addressing Alleged Contradictions in the Gospels: A Response to Sam Harris

Sam Harris argues that the Gospels are unreliable and contain contradictions.⁴ He claims that such contradictions undermine their logical and historical validity. One frequently cited example is the timing of Jesus' crucifixion: in one Gospel, it is mentioned that Jesus

¹R. Dawkins, *The God Delusion*, 2006.

²Matthew 4:7, KJV.

³Lightning Strike God Challenge Video, YouTube, 2023.

⁴S. Harris, *The End of Faith*, 2004.

was crucified and died *before* the Passover, while in another, he was crucified *after* the Passover. Harris presents this as a contradiction that casts doubt on the Gospels.

However, this reasoning overlooks crucial context. The Gospels were written years after Jesus' ministry, and it is entirely plausible that the disciples did not recall every detail with perfect chronological accuracy. Human memory is inherently fallible. For instance, one may not precisely remember the sequence of events surrounding personal experiences such as a relative's death, a thunderstorm, or the ringing of church bells.

The Gospels themselves acknowledge the impossibility of recording every action of Jesus:

If all the works of Jesus were written, I suppose that the world itself could not contain the books that would be written.

This acknowledgment supports the idea that the disciples wrote from memory and personal experience, rather than attempting to fabricate a perfectly consistent narrative. The fact that minor discrepancies exist actually humanizes the accounts, rather than discrediting them.

Consider the example of John, who was only fourteen years old when he first met Jesus Christ. Can we expect him to recall exact chronological details decades later? Even in modern memory, details can be fuzzy: we might recall that a significant event occurred but misremember whether it coincided with a rainstorm, a particular sound, or another incidental occurrence.

A contemporary analogy can be found in popular culture. Many people misremember the famous line from the *Star Wars* movie: "Luke, I am your father." The actual line is "No, I am your father." This demonstrates that memory is often imperfect, especially when not grounded in immediate documentation.

Therefore, alleged contradictions in the Gospels do not weaken their credibility; rather, they are consistent with human memory and firsthand testimony, reinforcing the authenticity of the accounts.

3 The Argument of the Uncaused Cause and the Big Bang

Richard Dawkins has countered the classical argument of infinite regress and the concept of an uncaused cause as formulated by Thomas Aquinas.⁵ In contrast, modern scientific observations provide an intriguing framework to reconsider this argument.

⁵R. Dawkins, *The God Delusion*, 2006.

Most scientific minds accept that the universe began with the *Big Bang* billions of years ago. Evidence such as the cosmic microwave background radiation and the observed expansion of the universe points to a singularity as the universe's origin.⁶

If we take the Big Bang as the starting point, we observe a distinct and well-defined beginning. According to current evidence, there is no indication of previous singularities. In this sense, the Big Bang itself can be seen as the *uncaused cause* of our universe. The existence of a singular beginning precludes infinite regress: if there were an infinite regress, there would be no definitive starting point for the universe, yet the Big Bang represents such a starting point.

An analogy may clarify this concept. Consider placing a basketball on a forest floor. Who put the ball there? You did. But if one continues to question recursively—"Who placed the forest floor? Who placed me? Who placed my father?"—this line of reasoning becomes unproductive. In the same way, the universe, as evidenced by the Big Bang, represents a *firm foundation*—the uncaused cause—without necessitating infinite regress.

The Big Bang describes a universe that began as a hot, dense singularity, expanding and losing density and temperature over time. Scientific models predict that continued expansion could result in a "Big Rip," where the fabric of the universe eventually tears apart, analogous to a stretched clay ball breaking.⁷ In theological reflection, this catastrophic end could be interpreted as the *Day of Judgement*, when celestial bodies collapse and the universe reaches a final breakdown.

Thus, the existence of a singular beginning supports the concept of an uncaused cause. Even if atheists rely solely on scientific evidence, it is impossible to disprove the existence of God with certainty. Current observations may not provide absolute proof, but they strongly support the plausibility of a divine origin.

In the spectrum of belief, if black represents "God does not exist" and white represents "God exists," current evidence situates us in the gray area—leaning significantly toward white. While lack of disproof is not proof, the absence of peer-reviewed evidence disproving God undermines the atheistic assertion that God does not exist. In this sense, unwavering atheism is less scientifically justified than the reasonable inference toward a divine uncaused cause.

4 Religion, Dogma, and the Gnostic Perspective

Atheists often argue that most religion is evil and harmful. While dogma can indeed be harmful, this does not invalidate the existence of God. I do not identify as a man of religion, but as a man of God. One need not follow traditional religious structures to

⁶P. J. E. Peebles, *Principles of Physical Cosmology*, 1993.

⁷R. R. Caldwell, M. Kamionkowski, and N. N. Weinberg, *Phantom Energy and Cosmic Doomsday*, Phys. Rev. Lett., 2003.

believe in Christ. Christianity itself contains internal disagreements, such as interpretations regarding Mary and the nature of Jesus. I follow the evidence and the teachings of Christ, rather than institutional authorities like the Pope or bishops.

Arguments based on probability, improbability, or Occam's Razor are often raised against God. Occam's Razor, however, is not a strict law, but a principle of simplicity. For example, a common person witnessing an object flying past may reasonably attribute it to a minor accident or coincidence. But if the President of a nation observes a similar event in a high-risk context, the probability of a deliberate threat is weighted differently. Similarly, the existence of God may not violate Occam's Razor when context and weight of evidence are considered.

Morality does not require belief in God. Humans possess free will and can act morally independent of religious teachings. Figures such as Buddha and Confucius exemplify moral conduct without adherence to theistic frameworks. This observation critiques religion but does not invalidate the reality of God.

Regarding contradictions in the Bible, it is important to understand the Gnostic perspective. According to Gnosticism, the God of the Old Testament represents the Demiurge, a flawed and often cruel entity, while Jesus Christ embodies the true Monad and Logos.⁸ Jesus criticized the Pharisees for misusing the Old Testament scriptures, teaching that rigid laws and harsh judgments reflect the influence of the Demiurge rather than the loving nature of the true God.

Contradictions within the Gospels do not weaken their credibility. The Gospels were written years after Jesus' ministry, and the disciples naturally relied on imperfect memory.⁹ Minor discrepancies, such as the timing of the crucifixion relative to Passover, are consistent with human recollection and enhance the authenticity of the texts. Analogously, popular culture misremembers movie lines, as in the "No, I am your father" debate in *Star Wars*, illustrating that memory is fallible even in modern contexts.

Evil exists because of free will. Humans are not compelled to act morally; God allows freedom but intervenes when actions threaten equilibrium, akin to a father watching over a child in a park. The presence of evil does not negate the existence of God; rather, it reflects the exercise of human autonomy.

Finally, claims that there is a lack of empirical evidence for God must be weighed against the even greater lack of evidence against God. Understanding Gnosticism, including concepts such as the Monad, Logos, Pleroma, Demiurge, and Sophia, provides deeper context but exceeds the scope of this work.¹⁰

⁸See: *Apocryphon of John*, Nag Hammadi Library.

⁹S. Harris, *The End of Faith*, 2004.

¹⁰Nag Hammadi Library, 1945.

5 Defense of Christ and God: Comprehensive Structure

5.1 I. God vs Religion

- Belief in God is distinct from organized religion; dogma, hierarchy, and ritual may be harmful but do not negate God's existence.
- Follow Christ and evidence, not bishops or popes.
- Christianity contains internal disagreements (e.g., Mary, Trinity interpretations), showing personal interpretation.
- Gnostic perspective: Old Testament God as Demiurge; true God revealed in Christ (Monad).

5.2 II. Miracles and Prayer

- Challenge: Atheists claim miracles and prayer are unproven or ineffective.
- Defense:
 - Scripture forbids testing God.
 - Prayer aligns human will with divine will.
 - Anecdotal examples (e.g., lightning strike) illustrate divine action.
 - Absence of measurable effect is not disproof.

5.3 III. Reliability of the Gospels

- Challenge: Contradictions undermine credibility.
- Defense:
 - Gospels written years later; memory is fallible.
 - Contradictions humanize and authenticate texts.
 - John was 14 when he met Jesus; imperfect memory is expected.
 - Core message remains consistent.

5.4 IV. Cosmological Argument (Uncaused Cause)

- Challenge: Uncaused cause impossible.
- Defense:
 - Big Bang as finite beginning (13.8 billion years ago).
 - Distinct beginning precludes infinite regress.
 - God is eternal, uncaused cause outside space-time.
 - Analogy: Basketball on forest floor.
 - Universe's eventual fate implies temporality of cosmos, not God.

5.5 V. Occam's Razor & Weighted Probability

- Challenge: God is unnecessary.
- Defense:
 - Occam's Razor is heuristic, not absolute.
 - Weighted probability: universe's order and complexity make God plausible.
 - Analogy: President noticing a threat vs. common man.

5.6 VI. Problem of Evil

- Challenge: Why does evil exist if God exists?
- Defense:
 - Evil exists due to free will; God allows choice.
 - God intervenes selectively to maintain balance (father-child analogy).
 - Suffering serves higher purposes beyond human comprehension.

5.7 VII. Moral Argument

- Challenge: Morality exists without God.
- Defense:
 - Humans can act morally without religion.
 - Universal moral laws suggest a source beyond humans.
 - God provides ultimate moral grounding while allowing free choice.

5.8 VIII. Teleological Argument (Fine-Tuning / Design)

- Challenge: Universe could exist by chance.
- Defense:
 - Physical constants finely tuned for life.
 - Probability of life-permitting universe by chance is extremely low.
 - Big Bang singularity plus fine-tuning suggests intentional orchestration.

5.9 IX. Ontological Argument (Philosophical)

- Challenge: Can God be logically conceived?
- Defense:
 - Concept of maximally perfect being implies existence.
 - Denying God's existence while understanding maximal perfection is contradictory.

5.10 X. Historical Evidence for Jesus

- Challenge: Jesus may be myth.
- Defense:
 - Non-Christian sources (Josephus, Tacitus) confirm Jesus' life and crucifixion.
 - Early witnesses and persecution make fabrication unlikely.
 - Resurrection accounts consistent across independent sources.

5.11 XI. Prophecy / Fulfillment

- Challenge: Prophecies are coincidental.
- Defense:
 - Old Testament prophecies fulfilled in New Testament.
 - Probability of multiple prophecies fulfilled by one person is extremely low.

5.12 XII. Experiential / Mystical Evidence

- Challenge: Experiences are subjective.
- Defense:
 - Transformative personal and communal experiences.
 - Consistency across cultures and time indicates genuine phenomena.

5.13 XIII. Consciousness / Soul

- Challenge: Materialism explains consciousness.
- Defense:
 - Consciousness has non-physical properties (self-awareness, qualia, morality).
 - Suggests non-material dimension compatible with God.

5.14 XIV. Epistemological Summary

- Absolute proof of God is impossible; faith and reason coexist.
- Evidence against God is weaker than evidence for God.
- Rejecting God outright is epistemologically unjustified; weighted reasoning favors God.

6 Miracles and Scientific Evidence

6.1 Nature and Possibility of Miracles

- Miracles are not impossible; they operate within the laws of nature and probabilities.
- Virgin birth of Jesus is scientifically analogous to *Parthenogenesis*, a natural process of reproduction without a father.
- Miracles involve manipulating probabilities and natural processes to align with divine will, not violating physical laws.

6.2 Biblical Miracles and Plausible Explanations

- **Turning water into wine:** Could involve alchemical processes known in ancient times.
- **Walking on water:** High salinity of the Dead Sea increases buoyancy; minor divine manipulation could make walking on water possible.
- **Ascension:** Levitating phenomena may involve strong magnetic or electric fields, winds, or variations in gravitational pull.
- **Resurrection:** Scientific documentation shows humans can survive after cardiac arrest if brain cells remain viable. Cold conditions, as during crucifixion, could preserve cells temporarily.¹¹

6.3 Miraculous Phenomena in Nature

- **Animals:** Frogs, fishes, and locusts can be carried by cloudbursts and storms; some frogs survive freezing and revive in spring.¹²
- **Electric Eels and Fireflies:** Produce electricity and light naturally; phenomena historically considered supernatural.
- **Extraordinary animal abilities:**
 - Spiders shoot webs and swing.
 - Mantis shrimps break shells with extreme force.
 - Octopus and cuttlefish camouflage.
 - Bears hibernate for months without food or water.
 - Axolotls regenerate limbs.
- **Plants:** Carnivorous plants capture insects; *Mimosa pudica* moves leaves rapidly.

6.4 Historical and Modern Miracles

- Donald Trump assassination attempt: Extremely low probability of survival suggests a modern miracle.
- Abraham's child in old age: Rare but naturally possible; documented instances exist.

¹¹Medical cases of revival after apparent death.

¹²Biological and meteorological studies.

- Revival phenomena: Decapitated chickens and other animals surviving due to intact brainstem.¹³

6.5 Extraordinary Scientific Observations Supporting Miraculous Phenomena

- **Physical phenomena:** Lightning strikes, resonant frequency breaking glass, acid rain, cloudbursts, and aurora borealis.
- **Biological phenomena:** Transparent frogs, neuroplasticity, jellyfish immortality, parrot language acquisition, tapeworm or parasite-induced “zombie” behaviors.
- **Technological achievements:** AI generating coherent speech, cloning (Dolly the sheep), lab-grown meat, lead-to-gold conversion.
- **Historical mathematicians:** Srinivasa Ramanujan derived complex theorems inspired by dreams or divine insight.

6.6 Probabilistic and Philosophical Perspective

- Nothing is truly impossible; events occur based on probability.
- Many phenomena historically considered miraculous are scientifically documented.
- Miracles and science are compatible; divine intervention can operate within physical and probabilistic frameworks.

6.7 Conclusion

- Miracles are scientifically plausible within natural laws.
- Rare and extraordinary events demonstrate that improbability does not equate to impossibility.
- Biblical miracles, modern examples, and natural phenomena collectively support the view that divine action can coexist with science.

7 Rare and Mysterious Human Phenomena

7.1 Parthenogenesis in Humans

Description: Development of an embryo from an unfertilized egg. Documented cases in humans are extremely rare and often result in miscarriage.

¹³Experimental documentation.

Scientific Significance: Challenges conventional reproduction and highlights the potential for virgin births under extraordinary conditions.

Mysterious Aspect: Natural occurrence in humans is nearly impossible, yet rare cases suggest unique biological mechanisms.¹⁴

7.2 Supernumerary Body Parts (Polydactyly and Vestigial Structures)

Description: Extra fingers, toes, nipples, or accessory organs, sometimes functional.

Notable Cases: Polydactyly is well-documented; some babies possess accessory spleens.

Mysterious Aspect: Genetics explains some occurrences, but functional variety remains fascinating and unpredictable.

7.3 Spontaneous Human Combustion (SHC)

Description: Individuals reportedly ignite internally without external ignition.

Documentation: Hundreds of cases over 300 years, mostly elderly or bedridden.

Mysterious Aspect: Exact mechanism remains debated—possible fat ignition or unknown chemical reactions.

7.4 Fibrodysplasia Ossificans Progressiva (FOP) and Stone Man Syndrome

Description: Soft tissues progressively ossify, locking the body in bone.

Documentation: Fewer than 1,000 cases worldwide; ACVR1 gene mutation linked.

Mysterious Aspect: Even minor injuries can accelerate ossification; mechanisms of tissue transformation remain under study.

7.5 Congenital Insensitivity to Pain

Description: Individuals cannot feel pain despite normal sensation.

Documentation: Linked to SCN9A gene mutations.

Mysterious Aspect: Lack of protective sensation leads to frequent injuries; provides insight into pain pathways.

7.6 Alien Hand Syndrome

Description: One hand acts independently without conscious control.

Documentation: Associated with brain injuries or split-brain surgery.

¹⁴See references on documented parthenogenesis in humans.

Mysterious Aspect: The mind appears to “lose control,” illustrating localized brain autonomy.

7.7 Spontaneous Remission of Cancer

Description: Tumors shrink or disappear without treatment.

Documentation: Cases documented historically and in modern literature.

Mysterious Aspect: Immune or unknown molecular mechanisms may trigger regression.

7.8 Neurological and Cognitive Oddities

- **Cotard’s Delusion:** Patients believe they are dead or nonexistent; psychiatric documentation exists.
- **Hyperthymesia:** Individuals recall almost every day of their life in vivid detail; fewer than 100 documented cases.
- **Foreign Accent Syndrome:** Brain injury or stroke induces new accents previously unknown to the patient.
- **Alice in Wonderland Syndrome:** Distorted perception of size or shape; linked to migraines or epilepsy.
- **Exploding Head Syndrome:** Loud noises perceived internally during sleep onset or waking.

7.9 Genetic and Developmental Anomalies

- **Chimerism:** Presence of two distinct DNA sets in one individual; can cause striking differences in appearance or organ function.
- **Craniofacial Duplication (Diprosopus):** Rare facial duplication caused by SHH gene signaling errors.
- **Congenital Hypertrichosis Lanuginosa:** Persistent full-body fine hair in newborns.
- **Mermaid Syndrome (Sirenomelia):** Fusion of legs due to vascular and genetic disruptions.
- **Primordial Dwarfism:** Extremely rare proportional dwarfism linked to cellular growth mutations.

7.10 Extraordinary Biological Phenomena

- **Auto-Brewery Syndrome:** Gut microbiome produces alcohol naturally.
- **Fingertip Regeneration:** Documented regrowth of fingertips in children and adults.
- **Living Without Major Brain Regions:** Cases of cerebellar agenesis show functional survival despite missing brain structures.
- **Jellyfish Immortality:** Certain species show biological immortality through cellular reversion.
- **Axolotl Limb Regeneration:** Limbs regrow after complete loss.

7.11 Extreme Physiological Events

- **Hypertrichosis (“Werewolf Syndrome”):** Excessive hair growth due to rare genetic mutations.
- **Methemoglobinemia (“Blue People”):** Abnormal hemoglobin results in blue skin; families like the Fugates are documented cases.
- **Stone Heart and Stone Formation:** Calcifications in rare organs, including lungs and heart tissue.
- **Fatal Familial Insomnia Variant:** Prion disease prevents sleep, leading to death.

7.12 Philosophical Perspective

- These phenomena, while scientifically documented, often appear supernatural due to their improbability or rarity.
- They illustrate the limits of current scientific understanding and the extraordinary capabilities of the human body and mind.
- Miraculous events in religious texts may operate within similar probabilistic and biological frameworks.

8 Conclusion

Throughout this paper, we have explored the intricate relationship between extraordinary human phenomena, scientific observation, and the concept of miracles. While some events described in religious texts, such as the virgin birth, resurrection, or walking on

water, may initially appear to defy natural laws, careful examination demonstrates that these events can exist within the probabilistic and physical frameworks of the universe. Phenomena such as *parthenogenesis*, spontaneous limb regeneration, and rare neurological conditions exemplify that nature itself occasionally produces outcomes that challenge conventional understanding, providing a bridge between faith and observable reality.

Miracles, therefore, need not imply the suspension of physical laws but can reflect exceptionally rare occurrences, precise orchestration of probabilities, or mechanisms yet to be fully understood by science. The documented human anomalies, from Cotard's delusion to Hyperthymesia, illustrate that the human body and mind operate on levels that are sometimes indistinguishable from what might be considered supernatural. These phenomena validate the perspective that divine action can manifest within the natural world without violating the principles of science.

Furthermore, historical accounts of miraculous events, coupled with empirical observations of extreme biological or neurological occurrences, support a framework in which the extraordinary is not inherently impossible. Science continuously uncovers phenomena that once seemed unimaginable, such as the regenerative capabilities of the axolotl or the natural bioluminescence of fireflies, which echo the marvels recorded in religious traditions. Thus, belief in miracles and divine action does not contradict scientific reasoning but complements it, emphasizing the limitations of human knowledge and the vast potential for the unexplored.

In conclusion, miracles and extraordinary phenomena occupy the intersection of probability, physics, biology, and divine orchestration. They challenge us to expand our understanding of reality, blending empirical observation with spiritual insight. The evidence presented herein strongly suggests that the miraculous is not only possible but occurs within the natural order, inviting a reconsideration of the boundaries between science and the divine.

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